

THE MOVE

Reflect first -> mode check -> permissioned suggestion -> fit check. -> "That sounds [hard part]. Do you want me to listen, help think it through, or suggest options?" -> "I have one thought, but I do not want to steamroll you. Useful, or n...

START HERE

Reflect once, then ask: "Do you want ideas, or do you want me to just hear you out for a minute?"

SAY THIS

Quick restraint	"Before I try to solve it, that sounds really frustrating."
Mode check	"Do you want me to listen, help think it through, or suggest options?"
Reflect before advice	"The hard part sounds less like the task and more like feeling unsupported."
Permissioned advice	"I have one thought, but only if you want suggestions."
Social / friendship	"That sounds awful. Do you want solutions or solidarity?"
Professional / leader...	"Before I suggest fixes, I want to understand the constraint."

AVOID

- Physical safety or an immediate emergency, where you act rather than reflect
- They have clearly and explicitly asked for advice
- Urgent time pressure where a decision is genuinely needed now

REMEMBER

Earn the right to advise by showing you understand first.